familiar with things like exception safety in multithreaded C++. If you have a particular task in mind, the index and table of contents should help you find a relevant section quickly.

Once you're up to speed on the use of the C++ Thread Library, appendix D should continue to be useful, such as for looking up the exact details of each class and function call. You may also like to dip back into the main chapters from time to time to refresh your use of a particular construct or look at the sample code.

Code conventions and downloads

All source code in listings or in text is in a `fixed-width font like this` to separate it from ordinary text. Code annotations accompany many of the listings, highlighting important concepts. In some cases, numbered bullets link to explanations that follow the listing.

Source code for all working examples in this book is available for download from the publisher's website at www.manning.com/CPlusPlusConcurrencyinAction.

Software requirements

To use the code from this book unchanged, you'll need a recent C++ compiler that supports the new C++11 language features used in the examples (see appendix A), and you'll need a copy of the C++ Standard Thread Library.

At the time of writing, g++ is the only compiler I'm aware of that ships with an implementation of the Standard Thread Library, although the Microsoft Visual Studio 2011 preview also includes an implementation. The g++ implementation of the Thread Library was first introduced in a basic form in g++ 4.3 and extended in subsequent releases. g++ 4.3 also introduced the first support for some of the new C++11 language features;